

- (e) Use a mixed combination of numbers, symbols and alphabets in your password so that it can have the maximum length.

Please note, you must also remember whether you typed in your name and master password in upper or lower case, because if you accidentally change the case for a letter in either the username or the master password, you will get a different password.

Site name: In this field, you need to give the website name you are creating the password for (you are advised to always use the domain name). For example, if you are creating a password for Twitter, just enter 'twitter.com' so that you won't forget the site name.

Aside from these basic ingredients, the Master Password app has other features that extend its functionalities.

Authentication type: Aside from passwords, some websites or services will require you to set up different types of authentication. For example, an ATM uses a PIN, not a password. So in order to facilitate various authentication needs, the Master Password app provides the following types of authentication.

1. Short password
2. Long password
3. Maximum length
4. PIN
5. Passphrase
6. Name

By default, 'Long password' will be chosen, but you can select what best suits your needs.

Password counter: If you want to generate a new password for your online account, all you need to do is increase the password counter (by default, the password counter value is set to 1). Now, to generate the new password, you just need to increase the counter to the value 2, and a brand new password will be displayed to you.

How does the Master Password app work?

Now that we have covered the basic concepts of the Master Password app, it is time to see it in action. As mentioned earlier, it is not a password manager so how does it generate a password? Let us take a sample user and see how the app generates a password.

Consider that our user is John Paul Jones and he's about to set a password for Twitter, using the Master Password app.

- (a) First, he opens the app and types his full name, John Paul Jones, in the name field.
- (b) Next, he enters his master password.
- (c) Finally, he enters the site's name — twitter.com

After he's finished, the generated password is shown below the name (Figure 3).

 **Note:** The screenshots are taken from the Web version of the Master Password app, since in the Android app screenshots aren't permitted.

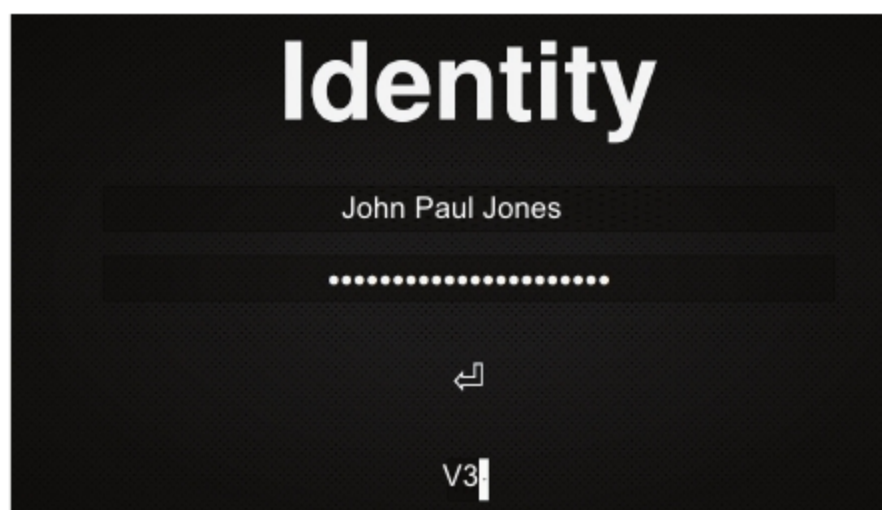


Figure 2: Entering the username and master password

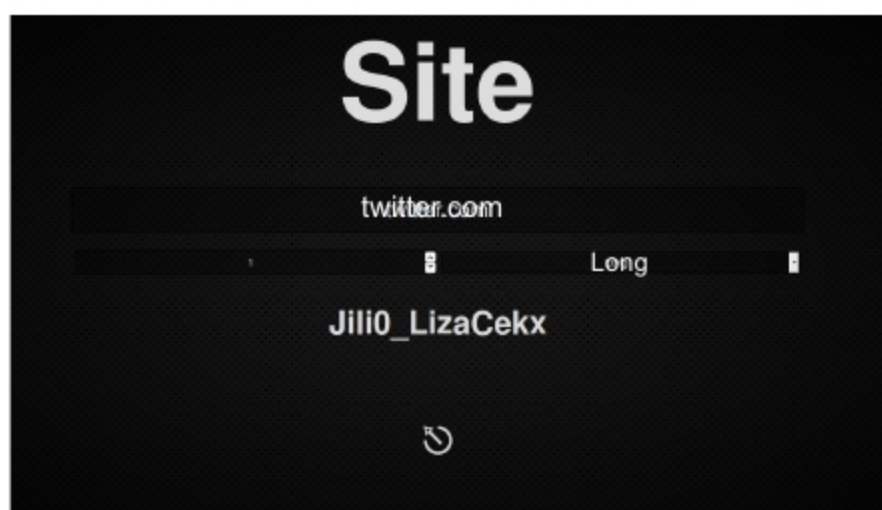


Figure 3: Password generated

$$2+2+2=6$$

To understand this app better, look at the above equation, which contains three input values and one result. As long as the input values are not changed, the result is always the same. The same result can be achieved by using the same inputs in various machines.

As long as your name, master password and site name remain the same, the resulting password will also be the same.

The advantages of the Master Password app

The Master Password app uses a simple but effective approach when it comes to generating passwords. The following features were designed into the app to strengthen its overall security.

No registration: Unlike most of the password managers, Master Password doesn't require any sort of registration on the app or elsewhere. You just need to open the app and start using it.

No storage: The data you enter and the generated passwords are never stored in the device or anywhere else because all that this app does is process three pieces of data and produce the output in runtime. So it doesn't require any sort of storage access.

No syncing or online access: When you want to use a password that was created on your phone or your office computer, you don't need an Internet connection to sync the passwords between the devices. All you need is to enter the same values on the app in the computer and you will get the correct password.